

Netiquette: How to be a Good Citizen Online

As programs are being delivered in an alternative format, online communication will be an essential part of your daily routine. We are providing you with some key points to help support your academic success at Sheridan and be a good citizen online. This document is full of tips that will assist you in communicating respectfully, sharing ideas, and studying remotely.



Positive online interactions will ensure the recipients receive the message you are trying to relay. If you are frustrated, take a step back from your keyboard/phone and wait to compose your message so that you don't communicate something you will later regret.

Emotional and Relational Content:

- **Avoid the use of humour and sarcasm:** Written comments can often be misinterpreted.
- **NO YELLING:** Avoid using the caps lock feature as this gives others the impression that you are yelling or upset.
- **Self-reflect:** Ask yourself if you would communicate this to a person in a face to face conversation or if this is kind. If the answer is no to either, do not send the communication.



Online Class (SLATE):

- **Minimize distractions:** Check that your background does not include any imagery that can be viewed as inappropriate, obscene, or offensive. You may want to disable your video.
- **Be professional:** Mute your side of the conversation when not speaking. Noises from paper shuffling, background music and/or others in your work area can all create distractions for others.
- **Be respectful:** Be respectful of other's opinions and ideas, even when their views may differ from yours.



Communication Etiquette with the Sheridan Community:

Regardless of who you are communicating with (Professors, fellow students, members of the Sheridan community), it is important to remember to:

- **Use proper grammar:** Avoid slang and texting abbreviations (i.e.: "lol," "brb," etc.) and emoticons as not everyone knows how to interpret them. Sheridan is an academic environment where professionalism is expected.
- **Review your email:** Spell check and proofread your emails for errors. This is especially important as it is critical to building your professional relationships and communication skills.
- **Be respectful to everyone:** Set a respectful tone and avoid using sarcasm. Remember to always use your recipients proper title and pronoun.
- **Sign your email:** Use your full name and student number. Assume the reader does not recognize your email address.
- **Use clear and concise language:** Be aware of the recipient's time by clearly stating the purpose of your communication.

Sending an Email to a Professor:

- Clearly state your questions, concerns, and/or requests.
- Professors will be able to help you better if you are clear and to the point.
- Introduce yourself and specify what class you are in.
- Briefly state the purpose of the email and the information the professor needs to know.
- Do not expect a response immediately. Please allow a reasonable amount of time for the faculty to respond to your email.
- Always be courteous and thank them for their time.



Connect With Us!

While our on-campus locations are closed, we're still here to support you. You can email us at askanadvisor@sheridancollege.ca and we'll connect you with the appropriate support team within The Centre for Student Success.



We wish you all the best in your studies and hope these tips will help create respectful communication and dialogue between you and members of the Sheridan community.

If you require this document in an accessible format, please contact The Student Rights and Responsibilities Office by email at srro@sheridancollege.ca.